

Across Borders: Outside Pressure

跨越边界：外部压力

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The outside pressure came from the **ambassador** of a **country** that had **become** famous for its **cheap** tickets. A **banner** on the wall read **FREEDOM OF THE COAST**, and a **nationwide sweep** had closed the little station by the **fence**. “A **comprehensive** review,” she said, “will tell us whether the road can **cope**.” **About** half the family had been **born inland**, and the rest had migrated to the **mainland**, and not one of them had been asked.

Meanwhile the **tonnage** through the port had begun to **fluctuate**, and the **odds** of a second war had widened the **breadth** of every insurance table. A **missile** on a **banner**, a **cool breeze** from the sea, and a **towel** on the **fence** of the **resort**: the place had the **makeup** of a **dull** postcard. “Things **vanish** here,” the head of the local company said. “Slowly, and then all at once.”

The **transportation** plan was a **leap** in the dark: a **collaboration** between an area office and a great house on the **coast**. A little car, a large door, and the name of a general on the letterhead gave it authority, and the **startle** it produced in the village was real. “Nothing **about** us without us,” the **occupant** of the second house said, and the **ambassador** wrote it down.

The **tremble** in her voice was not fear. “The war blurred the map once,” she said. “Do not let a **blast** of patriotism do it again.” A **slipper** by the door, an insertion in the local paper, and a broad **sweep** of the **inland road** were the only evidence they had, and it was enough to postpone the vote.

What became clear was that they had to **broaden** the road without widening the gap. “Something has to change,” the **ambassador** said, “and it will not be the family.” The **odds** of that had faded from likely to possible, and the company had already begun to look for a second site. A crisp **breeze**, a **cool** evening, and a small crowd at the door: the pressure had arrived, and it had a name. The **slow road** home, the **hometown** behind the **fence**, and the same small crowd at the door: it was enough.

中文翻译

外部压力来自一个以廉价车票出名的大使。墙上一条横幅写着“海岸的自由”，而一场全国性的清扫关掉了栅栏边那个小站。“一份全面的复审，”她说，“会告诉我们这条道路能否应付。”这家人约有一半出生在内地，其余迁到了大陆，而他们当中没有一个人被问过。

与此同时，通过港口的吨位开始波动，而第二场战争的概率拓宽了每一张保险表的宽度。横幅上的一枚导弹、海上吹来的一阵凉风，以及度假地栅栏上的一条毛巾：这个地方有着一张乏味明信片的妆容。“这里的東西会消失，”本地公司的负责人说，“慢慢地，然后一下子全没了。”

交通计划是黑暗中的一跃：一个地区办公室与海岸上一座大宅之间的合作。一辆小汽车、一扇大门，以及信头上一位将军的名字给了它权威，而它在村里引起的惊愕是真实的。“没有我们的参与，就不要替我们决定，”第二栋房子的住户说，大使把它记了下来。

她声音里的颤抖不是恐惧。“战争曾经把地图弄模糊过一次，”她说，“不要让一阵爱国主义的爆炸再来一次。”门口的一只拖鞋、本地报纸上的一条插入文字，以及内陆道路上一次广泛的清扫，就是他们仅有的证据，而这已足以推迟表决。

变得清楚的是：他们必须拓宽道路，却不能加宽那道裂缝。“总得有东西改变，”大使说，“而它不会是家庭。”这种可能性已经从“很可能”褪成了“也许”，而公司已经开始寻找第二个地点。一阵清爽的微风、一个凉爽的傍晚，以及门口的一小群人：压力已经到来，而且它有名字。回家那条缓慢的路、栅栏后面的故乡，以及门口的同一小群人：这些已经足够了。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
about ə'baʊt POS: prep	prep. 在...周围, 大约, 有关, 关于; adv. 大约, 四处, 在附近, 周围 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. on the move; r. all around or on all sides; r. in the area or vicinity; r. used of movement to or among many...
become bi'kʌm POS: vi	vi. 变成, 变得; vt. 适合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. enter or assume a certain state or condition; v. undergo a change or development; v. come into existence; v. ...
country 'kʌntri POS: n	n. 国家, 乡村, 地区, 故乡; a. 乡下的, 农村的; [计] DOS外部命令:用于设定国家代码, 包括日期时间及货币格式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the territory occupied by a nation; n. an area outside of cities and towns
born bɔ:n POS: a	a. 天生的; bear的过去分词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. British nuclear physicist (born in Germany) honored for his contributions to quantum mechanics (1882-1970)...
freedom 'fri:dəm POS: n	n. 自由, 坦率, 特权; [法] 自由, 自主, 免除 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the condition of being free; the power to act or speak or think without externally imposed restraints
cheap tʃi:p POS: a	a. 便宜的, 不值钱的, 可鄙的; adv. 便宜地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relatively low in price or charging low prices; s. embarrassingly stingy
cool ku:l POS: n	n. 凉爽, 凉爽的空气; a. 凉爽的, 冷淡的, 冷静的; vi. 冷却, 平息; vt. 使冷却, 使平静 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being at a refreshingly low temperature; v. make cool or cooler; v. lose heat; v. lose intens...
slow sləʊ POS: a	a. 慢的, 缓慢的, 迟缓的, 迟钝的, 冷漠的, 落后的; adv. 慢地, 迟缓地; v. (使)慢下来 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become slow or slower; v. cause to proceed more slowly; a. not moving quickly; taking a comparatively long t...
cope kəʊp POS: vi	vi. 竞争, 应付; n. 长袍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a long cloak; worn by a priest or bishop on ceremonial occasions; v. come to terms with
meanwhile 'mi:nhwaɪl POS: n	n. 其时, 其间; adv. 同时, 于此时 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. at the same time but in another place; r. during the intervening time
coast kəʊst POS: n	n. 海岸, 滑坡; v. 沿海岸而行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a slope down which sleds may coast; n. the area within view; v. move effortlessly; by force of gravity
missile 'misail POS: n	n. 发射物, 导弹, 飞弹, 火箭; a. 可发射的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a rocket carrying a warhead of conventional or nuclear explosives; may be ballistic or directed by remote...
transportation ˌtræns'pɔ:teɪʃən POS: n	n. 运输, 输送, 交通车辆; [经] 运转, 运输, 运输费 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of moving something from one location to another; n. the commercial enterprise of moving goods and...
comprehensive ˌkɒmpri'hensɪv POS: a	a. 广泛的, 有理解力的, 综合的; [经] 广泛的, 综合的, 全面的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. including all or everything; s. broad in scope
sweep swi:p POS: n	n. 扫除, 打扫, 肃清, 视野, 范围, 全胜; vt. 扫除, 掸去, 猛拉, 扫荡, 肃清, 冲走, 刮起, 环视, 掠过, 扫射; ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a wide scope; n. a long oar used in an open boat; n. a movement in an arc; v. move with sweeping, effortless,...
fence fens POS: n	n. 围墙, 栅栏, 买卖赃物的人, 剑术; vt. 用篱笆围住, 练习剑术, 防护; vi. 击剑, 搪塞 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a barrier that serves to enclose an area; n. a dealer in stolen property; v. enclose with a fence; v. receive...
resort ri'zɔ:t POS: n	n. 度假胜地, 手段, 凭借, 常去之地; vi. 诉诸, 常去 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a hotel located in a resort area
fade feɪd POS: vi	vi. 褪色, 消失, 凋谢; vt. 使褪色; n. 淡入, 淡出; a. 平淡的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. gradually ceasing to be visible; v. become less clearly visible or distinguishable; disappear gradually or...
odds ɒdz POS: n	n. 可能性, 几率, 机会, 胜算, 不平等 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the likelihood of a thing occurring rather than not occurring; n. the ratio by which one better's wager is...
makeup 'meɪkʌp POS: n	n. 组成, 性格, 化妆品, 化妆(术), 虚构, 补考 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. cosmetics applied to the face to improve or change your appearance; n. an event that is substituted for a p...
leap li:p POS: n	n. 跳跃, 剧增, 急变, 被越过之物; vi. 跳跃, 突然经过; vt. 跃过, 使跃过 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a light, self-propelled movement upwards or forwards; n. an abrupt transition; n. the distance leaped (or to)...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
towel 'tauəl POS: n	n. 手巾, 毛巾; v. 擦干身子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a rectangular piece of absorbent cloth (or paper) for drying or wiping; v. wipe with a towel
dull dʌl POS: a	a. 钝的, 无趣的, 呆滞的, 阴暗的; vt. 使迟钝, 使阴暗, 缓和; vi. 变迟钝, 减少 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make dull in appearance; v. become dull or lusterless in appearance; lose shine or brightness; v. make dull...
vanish 'væniʃ POS: vi	vi. 消失, 不见, 成为零 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become invisible or unnoticeable; v. cease to exist; v. decrease rapidly and disappear
homeland 'həʊmlænd POS: n	n. 本国, 故国 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the country where you were born
collaboration kə.ləbə'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 合作, 勾结; [法] 通敌卖国者, 奸细 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. act of working jointly; n. act of cooperating traitorously with an enemy that is occupying your country
breeze bri:z POS: n	n. 微风, 煤屑, 轻而易举的事; vi. 吹微风, 逃走 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a slight wind (usually refreshing); v. blow gently and lightly; v. to proceed quickly and easily
tremble 'treɪbl POS: n	n. 战栗, 颤抖; vi. 战栗, 忧虑, 摇晃 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a reflex motion caused by cold or fear or excitement; v. move or jerk quickly and involuntarily up and down...
ambassador æm'bæsədə POS: n	n. 大使; [法] 大使, 使节, 代理 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a diplomat of the highest rank; accredited as representative from one country to another; n. an informal re...
widen 'waɪdn POS: vt	vt. 弄宽, 加宽, 扩大; vi. 变宽, 扩大 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become broader or wider or more extensive; v. make wider; v. extend in scope or range or area
blast blæst POS: n	n. 一阵风, 爆炸, 枯萎病; vt. 炸, 使枯萎; vi. 炸, 猛攻, 猛烈抨击, 枯萎 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a very long fly ball; n. an explosion (as of dynamite); v. make a strident sound; v. use explosives on
nationwide 'neɪʃənwaɪd POS: a	a. 全国性的; [法] 全国的, 全国范围的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s occurring or extending throughout a country or nation; r extending throughout an entire nation
inland 'ɪnlənd POS: a	a. 内陆的, 国内的; n. 内地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. situated away from an area's coast or border; r. towards or into the interior of a region
banner 'bænə POS: n	n. 旗帜; a. 显著的, 特别好的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. long strip of cloth or paper used for decoration or advertising; s. unusually good; outstanding
mainland 'meɪnlənd POS: n	n. 大陆, 本土; [法] 大陆 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the main land mass of a country or continent; as distinguished from an island or peninsula
startle 'stɑ:tl POS: n	n. 惊愕, 惊恐; vt. 吃惊, 使惊愕; vi. 惊起 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sudden involuntary movement; v. to stimulate to action; v. move or jump suddenly, as if in surprise or ala...
blur blə: POS: vt	vt. 使模糊, 弄脏; vi. 弄脏, 模糊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a hazy or indistinct representation; v. to make less distinct or clear; v. make dim or indistinct; v. become...
occupant 'ɒkjupənt POS: n	n. 占有者, 居住者, 占用者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who lives at a particular place for a prolonged period or who was born there
migrate 'maɪgreɪt POS: vi	vi. 移动, 移往, 随季节而移居; [计] 迁移程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. move from one country or region to another and settle there; v. move periodically or seasonally
broaden 'brɔ:dn POS: vi	vi. 变宽, 扩大; vt. 放宽, 使扩大 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make broader; v. become broader
breadth bredθ POS: n	n. 宽度; [法] 违背, 违犯, 未遵守 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the capacity to understand a broad range of topics
slipper 'slɪpə POS: n	n. 拖鞋, 制轮器; vt. 用拖鞋打 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. low footwear that can be slipped on and off easily; usually worn indoors
insertion ɪn'sɜ:ʃən POS: n	n. 插入, 刊载, 插入物; [计] 插入 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of putting one thing into another
fluctuate 'flʌktʃueɪt POS: vi	vi. 变动, 起伏, 动摇; vt. 使波动, 使动摇 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to fluctuate or move in a wavelike pattern; v. move or sway in a rising and falling or wavelike patte...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
tonnage 'tʌnɪdʒ POS: n	n. 吨位; [化] 吨位 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a tax imposed on ships that enter the US; based on the tonnage of the ship